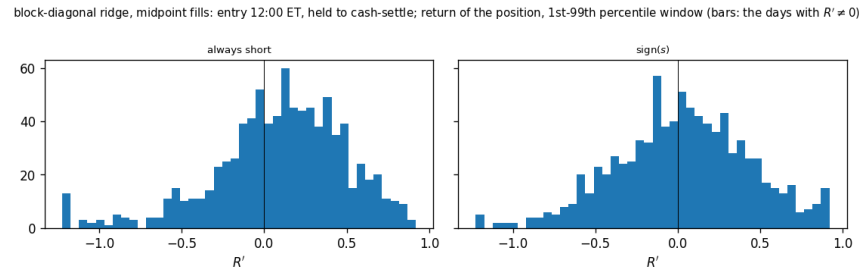


0DTE nearest-OTM straddle: per-rule return summary, entry 12:00 ET, held to cash-settle, models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe _{clk}	n_{buy}	%buy	Sharpe _{clk} ^x
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>												
all models (no forecast)	866	0.087	0.434	-2.97	0.93	-1.48	5.45	5.88	3.17	0	0.0	2.58
<i>sign(s) (± 1 on the sign of s)</i>												
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.025	0.442	-2.97	1.98	-0.67	4.12	1.68	0.91	364	42.0	0.33
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.033	0.442	-2.06	2.97	0.26	3.91	2.22	1.20	367	42.4	0.62
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.030	0.442	-2.06	2.97	0.27	3.90	2.03	1.09	379	43.8	0.51
LightGBM [†]	866	0.040	0.441	-2.10	2.97	0.09	3.97	2.67	1.44	360	41.6	0.86
XGBoost [†]	866	0.023	0.442	-2.06	2.97	0.07	3.95	1.52	0.82	372	43.0	0.24
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.025	0.442	-2.97	1.98	-0.60	4.10	1.64	0.88	385	44.5	0.30
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.036	0.441	-2.06	2.97	0.22	3.92	2.39	1.29	372	43.0	0.71
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.025	0.442	-2.10	2.97	0.08	3.95	1.67	0.90	382	44.1	0.32



Distribution of the return of the position taken at 12:00 ET, block-diagonal ridge forecast, one panel per rule (returns inside their 1st–99th percentile window).

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM straddle at 12:00 ET, hold those strikes to the official close, and delta-hedge every 30 minutes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and cash-settle at the official close (no exit spread). **Straddle** here means the nearest out-of-the-money call plus the nearest out-of-the-money put, same-day expiry, bought or sold as one position. One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. “ex. kurt” is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. **Two Sharpes.** Both multiply by $\sqrt{252}$ because an expiration day is the unit of time (same year-length as the paper). They are not the same object. On a *single-clock* page, $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{clk}} = (\text{mean}/\text{std}) \times \sqrt{252}$ of that clock’s series: one remaining-session short per expiration day (enter at this clock, hold those strikes to the close, delta-hedge every 30 minutes). It answers “if I only entered at this clock, what is my annual Sharpe?” It is *not* the book’s $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}}$. On the *pooled* page, $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}} = (\text{mean}/\text{std}) \times \sqrt{252}$ of $R_d^{\text{day}} = \sum_t R'_{d,t}$, the sum of the day’s thirteen overlapping remaining-session books. That reserved name is the book’s daily P&L after pooling the session. The thirteen books overlap; they are not thirteen successive holds. Sharpe^x is the same convention at the crossed spread. Every other column is daily. n_{buy} is the number of expiration days with position > 0 (always-short is 0; on the pooled page it is days the sum of the thirteen positions is positive); %buy is $100 \cdot n_{\text{buy}}/n$, the notebook’s column. The other column this table adds to the deck’s is $\text{Sharpe}_{\text{ann}}^x$, the same rule’s annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck’s.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). [†] marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - IV_{\text{hr}}^2 h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. w_t is the expanding mean of each prior day’s remaining-session share of realized variance, $RV_t / \sum_{s \geq t} RV_s$ (in-fit panel history back to 2001), not the ratio of trailing clock-means. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck’s treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the straddle midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat. At the 09:35 entry the forecast is the one issued at 09:30 for the 09:30–10:00 bar, w_t is that bar’s share, and h_t is the chain’s hours to the close.